

ARES

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Ares

OCCUPATION

God of War

BASES

New York, Olympus

HEIGHT 6 ft 1 in

WEIGHT 500 lbs

EYES Brown

HAIR Brown

FIRST APPEARANCE

Thor #129 (June 1966)

Superhuman strength, endurance, agility, and reflexes. Immortal with healing factor.

ARES

Born the son of Zeus and Hera, Ares is the Olympian god of war. Angered over Zeus allowing the Greco-Roman religion to fade away, he has tried to conquer Olympus several times, sometimes with the help of his uncle Pluto, the god of the afterlife. In many instances, his hated half-brother Hercules thwarted his plans, continuing their eons-old enmity.

Weary of his father's rule, Ares retired to Earth to raise his son Alexander as a mortal. He

returned to Olympus to battle Amatsu-Mikaboshi, the Japanese god of evil—but only once Alexander's life was at stake. After the Civil War (see pp. 84-5), he joined IRON MAN's AVENGERS, and he stuck with the team even after Norman Osborn (GREEN

GOBLIN) assumed control. Recently, Nick FURY recruited Alexander—who is actually Phobos, the god of fear—for his Secret Warriors, which Ares does not yet know. With Hercules joining an alternative team of Avengers, it is only a matter of time before the two old enemies meet. **MF**



As the God of War, Ares was born for battle and is more than willing to use modern weaponry to help him rage war.

ARKON

FIRST APPEARANCE Avengers #75 (April 1970)

REAL NAME Arkon ("The Magnificent")

OCCUPATION Ruler ("Imperion") BASE The planet Polemachus

HEIGHT 6 ft WEIGHT 400 lbs EYES Brown HAIR Brown

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Superhuman strength, speed, agility, and stamina; skin and muscles are more dense than that of humans; recovers from injury at a much faster rate than humans.

Arkon is a great leader and warrior on the planet Polemachus. The culture of Polemachus glorifies war and Arkon became his world's greatest warrior. As Imperion of the largest country on Polemachus, Arkon attempted to conquer the other nations of his world. But when Polemachus was faced with planet-wide annihilation, Arkon came to Earth believing that its destruction could save his homeworld. On Earth, IRON MAN teamed with THOR in a plan which saved Polemachus and stopped Arkon's aggression. **MT**



ARMADILLO

FIRST APPEARANCE Captain America Vol. 1 #308 (August 1985)

REAL NAME Antonio Rodriguez

OCCUPATION Professional wrestler BASE Mobile

HEIGHT 7 ft 6 in WEIGHT 540 lbs EYES Brown HAIR None

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Body resembles that of a gigantic humanoid armadillo, with sharp claws and armor plating; possesses superhuman strength and durability.

When his wife became mortally ill, Antonio Rodriguez turned to Dr. Karl Malus, who promised to try to cure her if Antonio worked for him and submitted to his experiments. Malus combined genes from an armadillo with Rodriguez's genes, transforming him into a super-powerful being resembling a humanoid armadillo. Malus assigned the Armadillo to invade the WEST COAST AVENGERS Compound. There Captain America defeated the Armadillo but realized he was not a criminal at heart. Though the Armadillo has sometimes run afoul of the law, he prefers to earn his living in wrestling matches against super-strong opponents. **PS**



ARMORY

FIRST APPEARANCE Avengers: The Initiative #1 (April 2007)

REAL NAME Violet Lightner

OCCUPATION Former hero BASE Camp Hammond, CT

HEIGHT 5 ft 6 in WEIGHT 110 lbs EYES Green HAIR Purple

SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Wore the Tactigon, an alien weapon capable of morphing into any weapon necessary.

As suicidal teen Violet Lightner leapt from the Golden Gate Bridge, an alien weapon called the Tactigon, shot from the water, attached itself to Lightner's arm, and transformed into a grappling hook that saved her. After helping the AVENGERS defeat the giant robot ULTIMO, Lightner joined the Fifty State Initiative (see pp. 118-9) and reported to Camp Hammond as part of the first class of trainees. During her first combat training session, teammate Trauma triggered her arachnophobia, and Lightner panicked. Wild shots from the Tactigon blew off KOMODO's arm and killed MICHAEL VAN PATRICK. Lightner was removed from duty, and surgeons stripped her of the Tactigon. **MF**

